SUBJECT GUIDE

History — ancient to modern

Chronological modules with the exact NCERT chapters (old and new books) for each period.

11	38	49
Modules	Topics	NCERT chapters

Asked in: UPSC · State PSC · SSC · Railway · TET/TRE · Police

Contents

1 Prehistory & Harappan civilisation
2 Vedic age, Mahajanapadas & Mauryas
3 Post-Mauryan, Guptas & Sangam age
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5 Mughals, Vijayanagara, Marathas & regional states
6 Bhakti–Sufi movements & medieval culture
7 Company rule & the Revolt of 1857
8 Reform movements & the national movement
9 Making of the Constitution & India after 1947
10 World history
11 Art & culture

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MODULE 1

Prehistory & Harappan civilisation

- ☐ Stone ages, sources of history
- ☐ Harappan cities, town planning, sites and rivers
- ☐ Trade, crafts, decline

How it's asked: Site ↔ river ↔ present state matching (e.g. Lothal–Bhogava–Gujarat) is a favourite.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

NCERT Class 6 · Timeline and Sources of History · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 6 · The Beginnings of Indian Civilisation · PDF ↗

NCERT Class 12 · Bricks, Beads and Bones: The Harappan Civilisation · PDF ↗

NIOS NIOS History (315) ↗

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MODULE 2

Vedic age, Mahajanapadas & Mauryas

- ☐ Vedic literature & society
- ☐ 16 Mahajanapadas, rise of Magadha
- ☐ Buddhism & Jainism
- ☐ Mauryan empire, Ashoka's dhamma & edicts

How it's asked: Asked as: capital of a Mahajanapada, Buddhist councils (place–king), Ashokan edicts.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 7 · New Beginnings: Cities and States · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 7 · The Rise of Empires · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 12 · Kings, Farmers and Towns: Early States and Economies · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 12 · Kinship, Caste and Class: Early Societies · PDF ↗

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MODULE 3

Post-Mauryan, Guptas & Sangam age

- ☐ Kushanas, Satavahanas, Sangam kingdoms
- ☐ Gupta administration, art, science
- ☐ Literature & travellers (Fa-Hien)

How it's asked: Who wrote what (Kalidasa, Aryabhata, Varahamihira) and which dynasty built what.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 7 · The Age of Reorganisation · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 7 · The Gupta Era: An Age of Tireless Creativity · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 12 · Thinkers, Beliefs and Buildings: Cultural Developments · PDF ↗

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MODULE 4

Early medieval India & Delhi Sultanate

- ☐ Rajputs, Palas, Pratiharas, Rashtrakutas, Cholas
- ☐ Delhi Sultanate dynasties and reforms
- ☐ Administration & economy

How it's asked: Ruler ↔ reform (e.g. Alauddin's market control) and dynasty order are asked often.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 7 · Empires and Kingdoms: 6th to 10th Centuries · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 7 · Turning Tides: 11th and 12th Centuries · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 7 · Kings and Kingdoms · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 7 · Delhi: 12th to 15th Century · PDF ↗

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MODULE 5

Mughals, Vijayanagara, Marathas & regional states

- ☐ Mughal rulers, mansabdari, revenue
- ☐ Vijayanagara & Bahmani
- ☐ Rise of the Marathas
- ☐ 18th-century regional powers

How it's asked: Battles (year–between whom) and administrative terms (mansab, jagir, chauth) are classic questions.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 7 · The Mughals (16th to 17th Century) · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 12 · An Imperial Capital: Vijayanagara · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 12 · Peasants, Zamindars and the State: Agrarian Society and the Mughal Empire · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 8 · Reshaping India's Political Map · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 8 · The Rise of the Marathas · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 7 · Eighteenth-Century Political Formations · PDF ↗

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MODULE 6

Bhakti–Sufi movements & medieval culture

- ☐ Bhakti saints & their regions
- ☐ Sufi silsilas
- ☐ Regional cultures, architecture

How it's asked: Saint ↔ region ↔ language matching.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 12 · Bhakti-Sufi Traditions: Changes in Religious Beliefs and Devotional Texts · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 7 · Devotional Paths to the Divine · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 7 · The Making of Regional Cultures · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 8 · Cultural Currents: 13th to 17th Centuries · PDF ↗

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MODULE 7

Company rule & the Revolt of 1857

- ☐ Battles of Plassey & Buxar
- ☐ Revenue systems (Permanent, Ryotwari, Mahalwari)
- ☐ Tribal & peasant revolts
- ☐ 1857: centres, leaders, causes

How it's asked: Revolt centre ↔ leader ↔ British officer who suppressed it.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 8 · From Trade to Territory: The Company Establishes Power · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 8 · Ruling the Countryside · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 8 · Tribals, Dikus and the Vision of a Golden Age · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 8 · When People Revolt: 1857 and After · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 8 · The Colonial Era in India · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 12 · Colonialism and the Countryside: Exploring Official Archives · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 12 · Rebels and the Raj: The Revolt of 1857 and Its Representations · PDF ↗

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MODULE 8

Reform movements & the national movement

- ☐ Social & religious reformers
- ☐ Gandhian movements (Champaran → Quit India)
- ☐ INC, moderates & extremists
- ☐ Revolutionaries, partition & independence

How it's asked: Chronology (put events in order) and "who founded…" are the most common forms.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 8 · Civilising the "Native", Educating the Nation · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 8 · Women, Caste and Reform · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 8 · The Making of the National Movement: 1870s–1947 · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 10 · Nationalism in India · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 12 · Mahatma Gandhi and the Nationalist Movement: Civil Disobedience and Beyond · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 8 · India's Long Road to Independence · PDF ↗

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MODULE 9

Making of the Constitution & India after 1947

- ☐ Constituent Assembly & committees
- ☐ Nation building
- ☐ Integration of states

How it's asked: Committee ↔ chairman and key dates (26 Nov 1949, 26 Jan 1950).

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 12 · Framing the Constitution: The Beginning of a New Era · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 12 · Challenges of Nation Building · PDF ↗

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MODULE 10

World history

- ☐ Nationalism in Europe
- ☐ Print culture
- ☐ Industrial revolution & global economy
- ☐ Early societies & empires

How it's asked: UPSC/State PSC ask causes & outcomes; SSC asks “which revolution/when”.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 10 · The Rise of Nationalism in Europe · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 10 · The Making of a Global World · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 10 · The Age of Industrialisation · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 10 · Print Culture and the Modern World · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 11 · Writing and City Life · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 11 · An Empire Across Three Continents · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 11 · Paths to Modernisation · PDF ↗

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MODULE 11

Art & culture

- ☐ Temple & Indo-Islamic architecture
- ☐ Religions, festivals, heritage sites
- ☐ Dance, music, painting

How it's asked: Monument ↔ builder ↔ city, dance ↔ state, UNESCO sites.

READ (FREE, OFFICIAL)

- NCERT Class 12 · Thinkers, Beliefs and Buildings: Cultural Developments · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 8 · A Journey Through Indian Architecture · PDF ↗
- NCERT Class 7 · India, a Home to Many · PDF ↗
- NIOS NIOS Indian Culture & Heritage (223) ↗
- OFFICIAL UNESCO World Heritage sites in India ↗

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